

Yue Yao

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RESEARCH PROFILE

Interdisciplinary researcher focused on embodied AI, robotic co-design, and algorithmic accountability. Combines Data Science and AI training at Columbia with research in human-robot interaction and regulatory responsiveness, and institutional AI workflows.

EDUCATION

Columbia University, SIPA & Columbia Business School

M.I.A. / M.B.A. | Focus: Data Science & Artificial Intelligence

Relevant coursework: Robotics Studio, Computer Graphics, Robotics Foundations, Building AI Tools with LLMs, AI for Policy, Database Design.

Expected May 2028

New York, NY

University of Oxford

M.St., History of Art and Visual Culture

Oct 2020 - Jul 2021

Oxford, UK

University of British Columbia

B.A. (Honours), Art History

Sep 2016 - May 2020

Vancouver, Canada

RESEARCH & PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Columbia University, Creative Machines Lab

Research Collaborator, Creative Robotics & Embodied AI

- Conduct collaborative research in robotic co-design, simulation, embodied AI, and human-robot interaction.
- Co-authored *Locomotion Selects for Symmetry*, comparing evolutionary morphology search and reinforcement-learning control in abstract and CAD-informed simulations; submitted to an IROS workshop.

Jun 2026 - Present

New York, NY

United Nations

Data and AI Fellow

- Support AI-enabled workflows for crisis-response financing and institutional analysis using Python, LLM tools, and structured data pipelines to synthesize unstructured reports.

Jun 2026 - Present

New York, NY

TouchTronix Robotics

Data Science Intern

- Evaluated companion-robot applications and market opportunities; translated embodied-AI research into product strategy.

May - September 2026

New York, NY

China Europe International Business School (CEIBS)

Research Assistant, Management Science

- Authored business cases and white-paper research on entrepreneurship and internationalization; built an experiential UI/UX platform for management education.

Mar 2024 - Aug 2025

Shanghai, China

Shanghai Pudong Development Bank (Headquarters)

Management Associate

- Developed policy frameworks across 34 regions and SQL-based talent dashboards supporting workforce planning.

Aug 2022 - Mar 2024

Shanghai, China

SELECTED RESEARCH & PROJECTS

ReTracing: Body, Machine & Generative Systems

Co-first Author | NeurIPS Creative AI / CVPR Art Gallery

- Co-architected a language-to-motion pipeline for a human performer and Unitree Go2 quadruped, reconstructing interactions as 3D traces; applied SAM-based segmentation and shared the research workflow.

May 2024 - Dec 2025

New York / Pittsburgh

AI Governance, Institutional Visibility & Financial RAG Systems

Data Analyst, Network Analysis & AI Validation

- Built policy and cultural datasets using graph analysis, entity resolution, and Python/Tableau; developed an evidence-grounded SEC 10-K RAG system with retrieval, risk classification, and abstention logic.

Dec 2025

New York, NY

Oxford China Forum & Entrepreneurship Club

Panel Director & Executive Member

- Curated AI, art, and entrepreneurship events engaging 200+ participants.

Aug 2020 - May 2021

Oxford, UK

SELECTED PAPERS, CASES & EXHIBITIONS

- Jianing Fan*, Yue Yao*. *Who Gets Heeded? An Obligation-Level Audit of Responsiveness in EPA Rulemaking*. ACM EAAMO 2026 - accepted for oral presentation.
- Jiong Lin, Yue Yao, Hod Lipson. *Locomotion Selects for Symmetry: Evolutionary Co-Design of Legged Robots on an Icosahedral Body*. Submitted to an IROS workshop.
- Yitong Wang*, Yue Yao*. *ReTracing: An Archaeological Approach Through Body, Machine, and Generative Systems*. NeurIPS 2025 Creative AI Track; CVPR 2026 Art Gallery.
- Yue Yao, Yitong Wang. *Unveiling Bodies*. ICSR 2026 Grand Challenge - Art finalist.
- Jean Lee, Yue Yao. *Entering Africa: Challenges Faced by Lü Cui Feng, CEO of CJ Smart Cargo Group*. Award-winning CEIBS case, 2025 Global Contest for the Best China-Focused Cases.
- Research contributor, CEIBS *Internationalization of Family Business* white paper (2024): Teckwah and Brico Group cases.
- * Co-first authors; equal contribution.

SKILLS

Technical: Python, R, SQL, Bash, MATLAB, Tableau, Excel/VBA, machine learning, NLP/LLM workflows, data visualization

AI/Robotics: Embodied AI, robot learning, human-robot interaction, multimodal data pipelines, diffusion/imitation learning

Languages: Chinese and English fluent; Japanese and Latin basic.